

PROJECTS

Is United States, Not Texas.

Sharing Codes

The Yellow Juice

Is United States, Not Texas.

PROCESS

The Problem's Problem
Zooming out

Design Approach

Research + Conceptualisation

Design boolean logic conditions (AND/OR/NOT) into the Advanced search filters of a people intelligence platform.

The problem: Users couldn't search for "CEOs in the US but not Texas, who donated \$20k to education but not to Harvard." AND/OR/NOT didn't extend across all available filters.

Why it mattered: Four legacy brands already did this in some capacity, and we were migrating their users to Altrata. Parity was the condition of the migration, not a feature request. The cost of missing it was churn and lost renewals.

My position: The immediate ticket scoped boolean to location filters only. I pushed for solving it across all of them, and got the time to do it. A partial fix would have meant rebuilding it later.

Work location

Is United States and United Kingdom or not Texas or and London

+ add condition

Project Partner: Altrata, London (Ongoing)
Lead Designer: Varsha Elango
Team Members: Designer, Project Manager

UX/UI Design Interaction Design
User Testing Prototyping Product Strategy

Two requirements arrived with almost the same need. One was urgent and small, one larger and scheduled for later. A quick win would hit parity fast, but guarantee a revision loop for everything else. Double the work, double the time.

- Boolean logic in Location filters only
- Boolean logic in Location filters + all other filters

I made the case for solving it once, properly, and got the scope changed. Solve for tomorrow, and today solves itself.

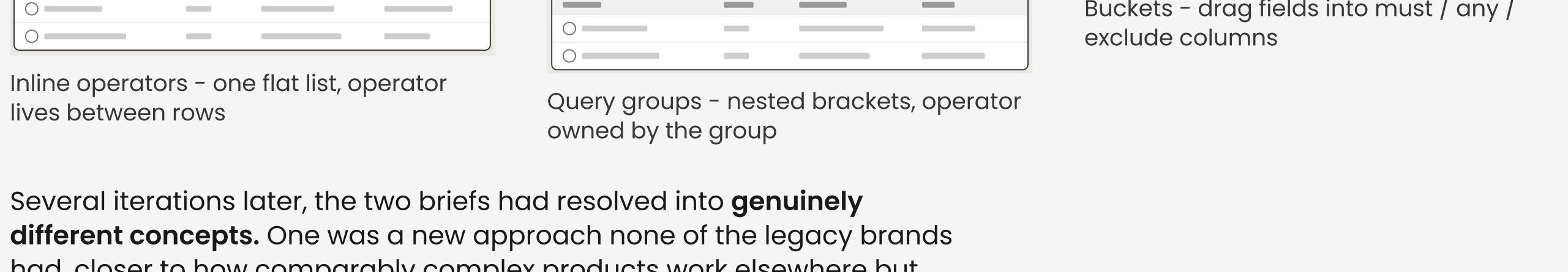
I set out a clear approach for my team to proceed with.

Ticket → Define the bigger scope → Research → Design → Test concepts with users → Find out → Build faster with AI

We started from past session recordings of clients using advanced search, alongside secondary research into how boolean logic actually works. Boolean had to sit above the launched feature, and designing inside that structure looked like it would force compromises.

Rather than assume that, I split the exploration deliberately. I directed my designer to work boolean into the existing advanced search, and took the opposite brief myself: question the current approach and design from a new perspective. Testing could then tell us whether something better existed.

I drew variations and used Claude to translate them into low-fi wireframes.



Inline operators – one flat list, operator lives between rows

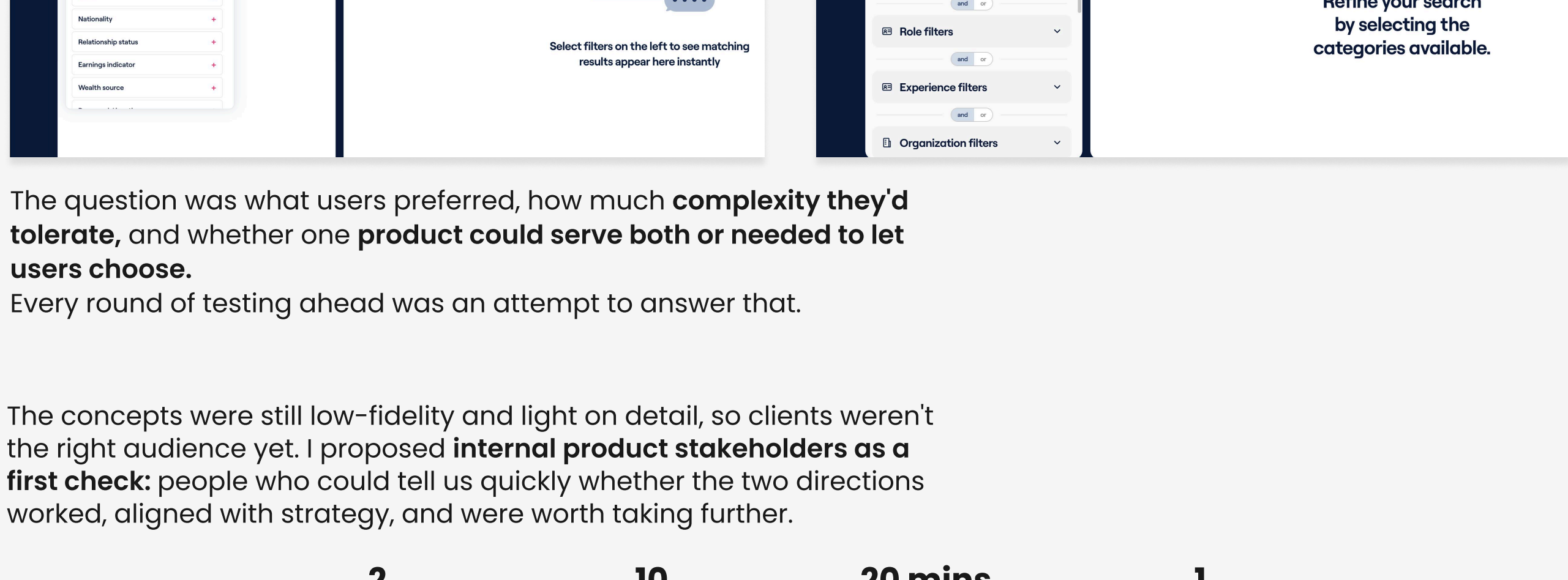
Query groups – nested brackets, operator owned by the group

Buckets – drag fields into must / any / exclude columns

Several iterations later, the two briefs had resolved into genuinely different concepts. One was a new approach none of the legacy brands had, closer to how comparably complex products work elsewhere but tuned to Altrata. The other embedded boolean into the current structure, with all filters displayed at once.

Concept A (mine) assumes you think in rules, and gives you a blank slate to build one.

Concept B (Zara's) assumes you think in filters, and fits boolean into the modules you already use.



The question was what users preferred, how much complexity they'd tolerate, and whether one product could serve both or needed to let users choose. Every round of testing ahead was an attempt to answer that.

Design Toolkit

Prepping for Testing

Speed as a research method.

Claude turned sketches into low-fi wireframes and interactive prototypes fast enough to test with evidence. That meant 28 participants across 3 rounds in 6 weeks, clicking real interactions rather than static screens.

For a problem this abstract, that was the difference between opinion and evidence.

Expectation vs Reality

Round 1

Testing returned a tie.

we love Concept A! (50%)

we love Concept B! (50%)

"Rule builders are the new age filters now." (Data Product Manager)

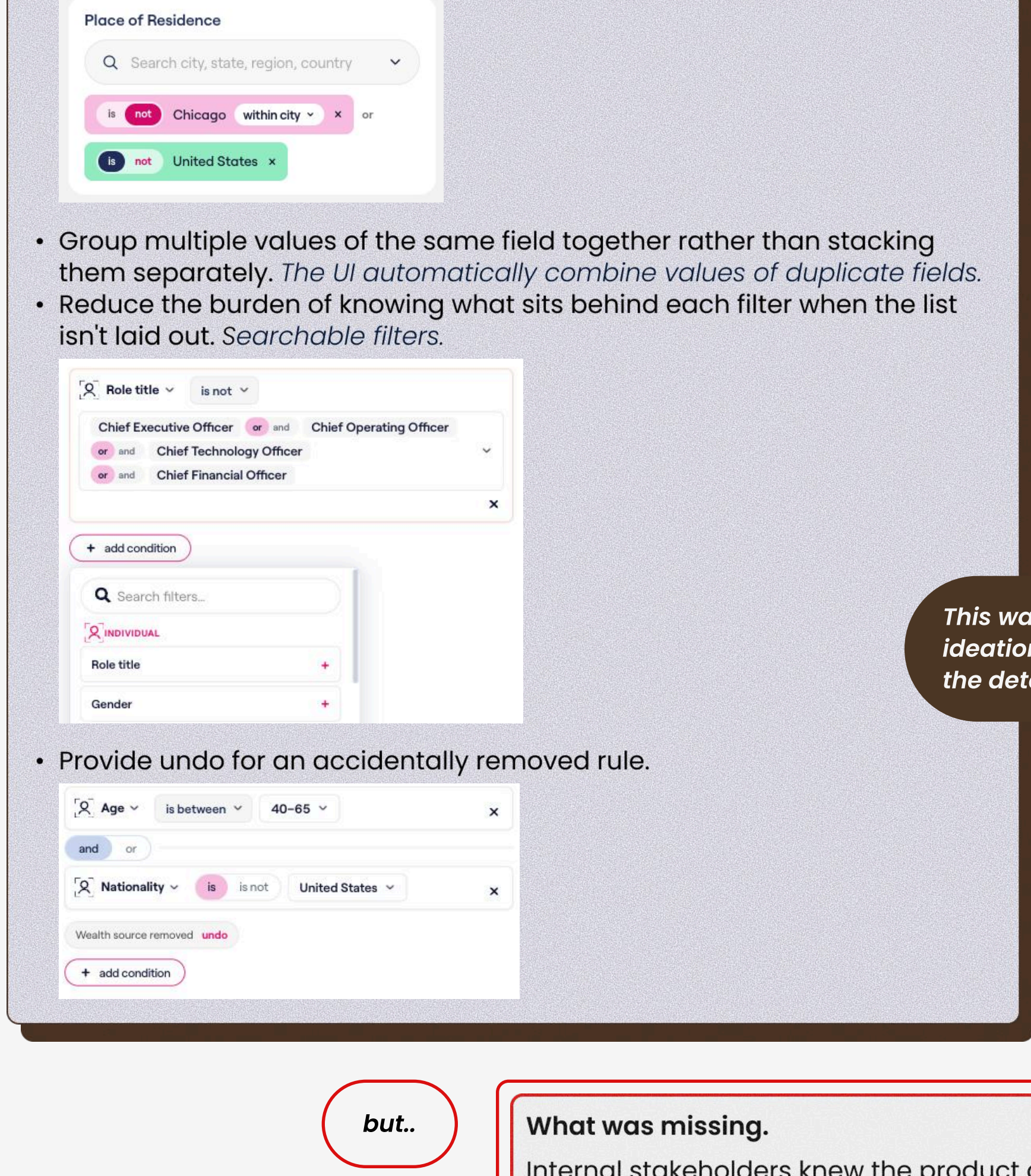
"I like to see all the options available to me. That helps me make a decision." (Developer)

"I got something pretty complex in like a minute and a half, that's very helpful." (Account Manager)

"I feel like it should just be baked in. It's just an extra step that I don't think I need to take." (Senior Product Manager)

"Having and/or idea on each filter makes it quite confusing for me. Whereas this makes it incredibly simple." (Product Director)

"It opens a completely new UI for us to build a query, and it was not very intuitive for me." (Product Manager)



but...

What was missing.
Internal stakeholders knew the product and gave us good enhancement ideas, but no real use cases. Useful for shaping the concepts, not for choosing between them.

The Upgrade

Round 2 of testing

To fill that gap I proposed a closer proxy: Commercial and Customer Success, who spend the most time with clients. It also bought time to deepen the concepts before reaching real users.

2 Updated concepts

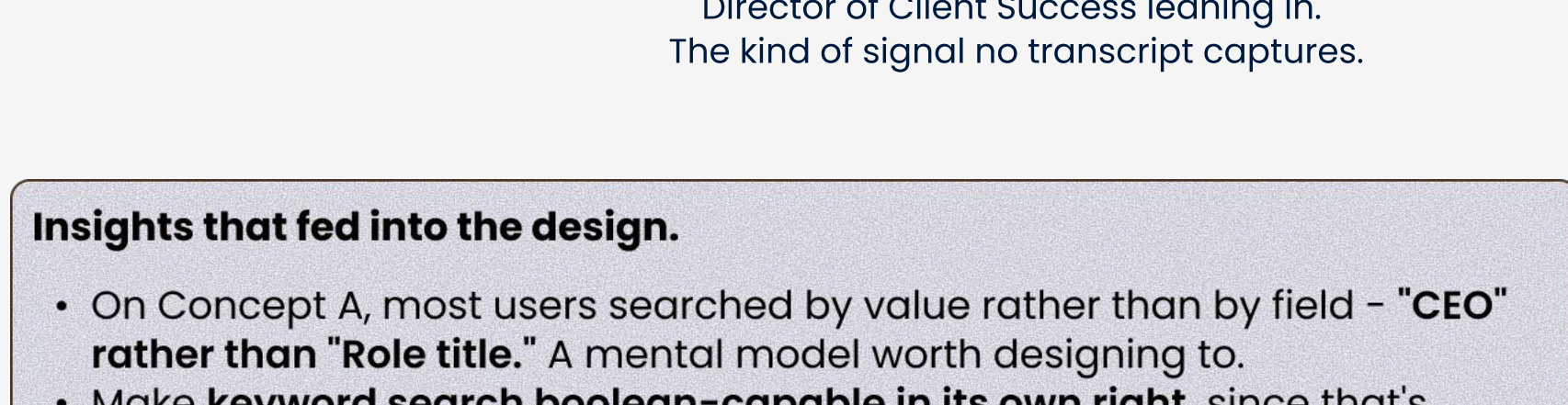
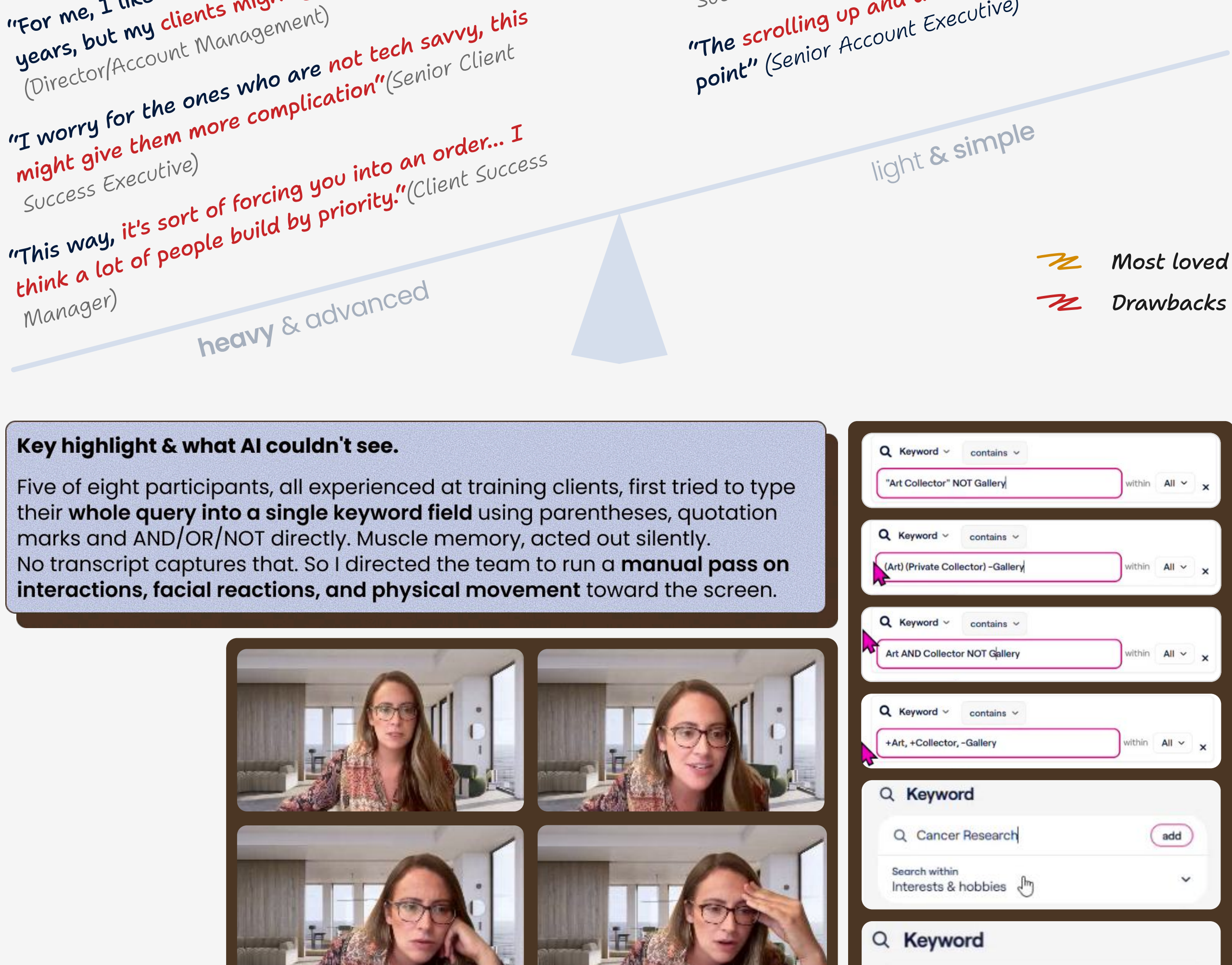
8 Commercial & CS

30-40 mins per session

1 week

with interactive prototypes, built with Claude AI

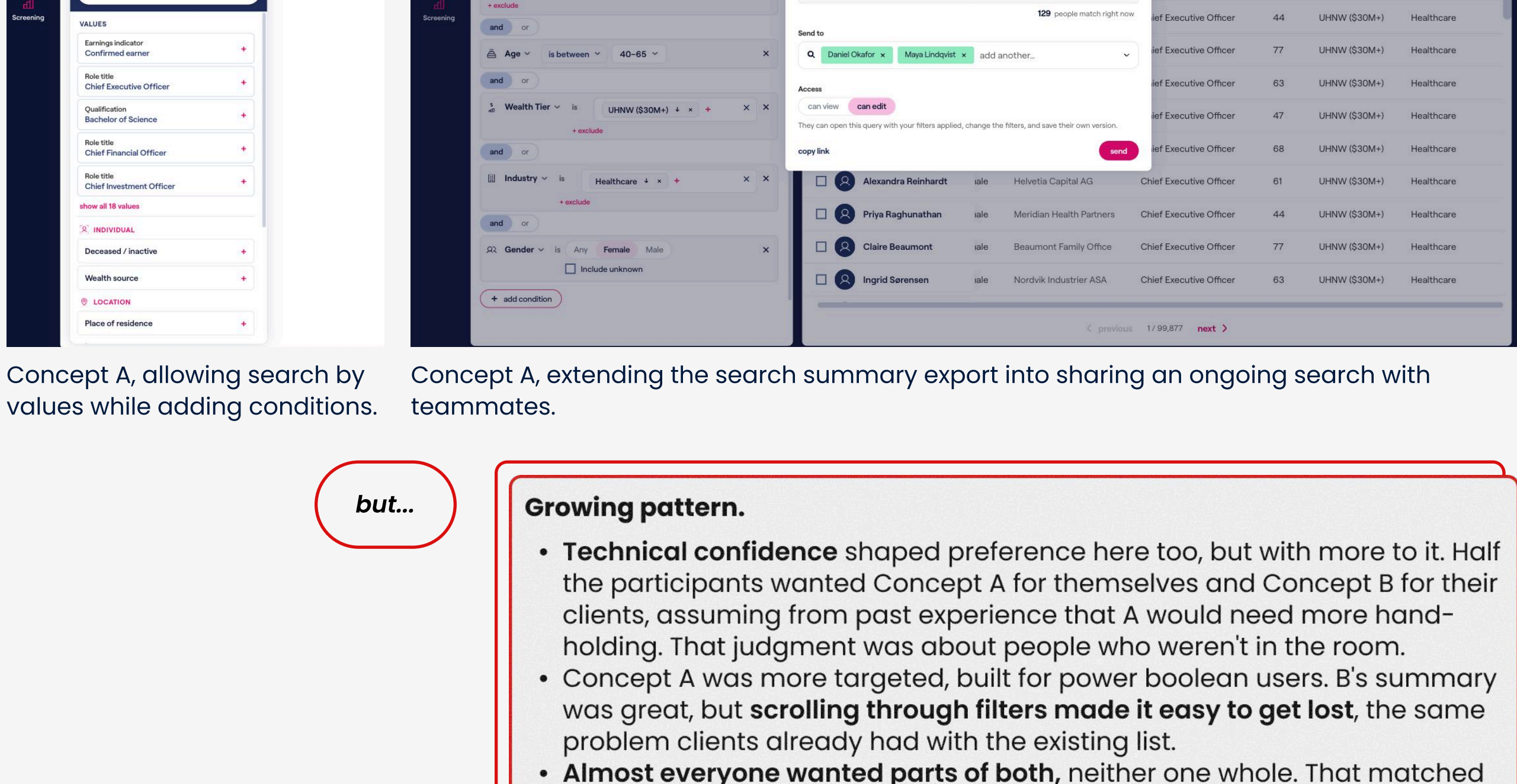
Round 2 gave us a lot of insight, alongside a pattern of bias. Close as they were to clients, their read was still secondhand.



Insights that fed into the design.

- On Concept A, most users searched by value rather than by field – "CEO" rather than "Role title." A mental model worth designing to.
- Make keyword search boolean-capable in its own right, since that's where people instinctively went first.
- The readable summary can extend into exports, so gift officers and managers not using the platform still see the criteria.
- A clearer toggle for what advanced logic will do.

Sharpened both concepts considerably.



Concept A, allowing search by values while adding conditions.

Concept A, extending the search summary export into sharing an ongoing search with teammates.

but...

Technical pattern.

- Growing confidence shaped preference here too, but with more to it. Half the participants wanted Concept B for themselves and Concept A for their clients, assuming from past experience that A would need more hand-holding. That judgment was about people who weren't in the room.
- Concept A was more targeted, built for power boolean users. B's summary was great, but scrolling through filters made it easy to get lost, the same problem clients already had with the existing list.
- Almost everyone wanted parts of both, neither one whole. That matched our instinct, though it needed real users to confirm.

and...

What should be improved.

- We showed Concept A first to some participants and B first to others, and saw that whichever came first gave people time to warm to boolean before the second. We needed to reduce that influence in the next round.
- We asked people to think of a complex query live in the session, which was difficult to do on the spot. A heads-up to prepare one beforehand would have helped.

Getting to the clients

Round 3 – A/B Split

To tackle concept bias, I proposed an A/B split for round 3, tracking discoverability, onboarding and feature adoption. Client time is the scarcest resource. What comes back from commercial is consistently "clients are busy," we can't bother them now," "show them the final version." Round 3 took three weeks against one for the earlier rounds, and that's why.

2 Refined high-fidelity concepts

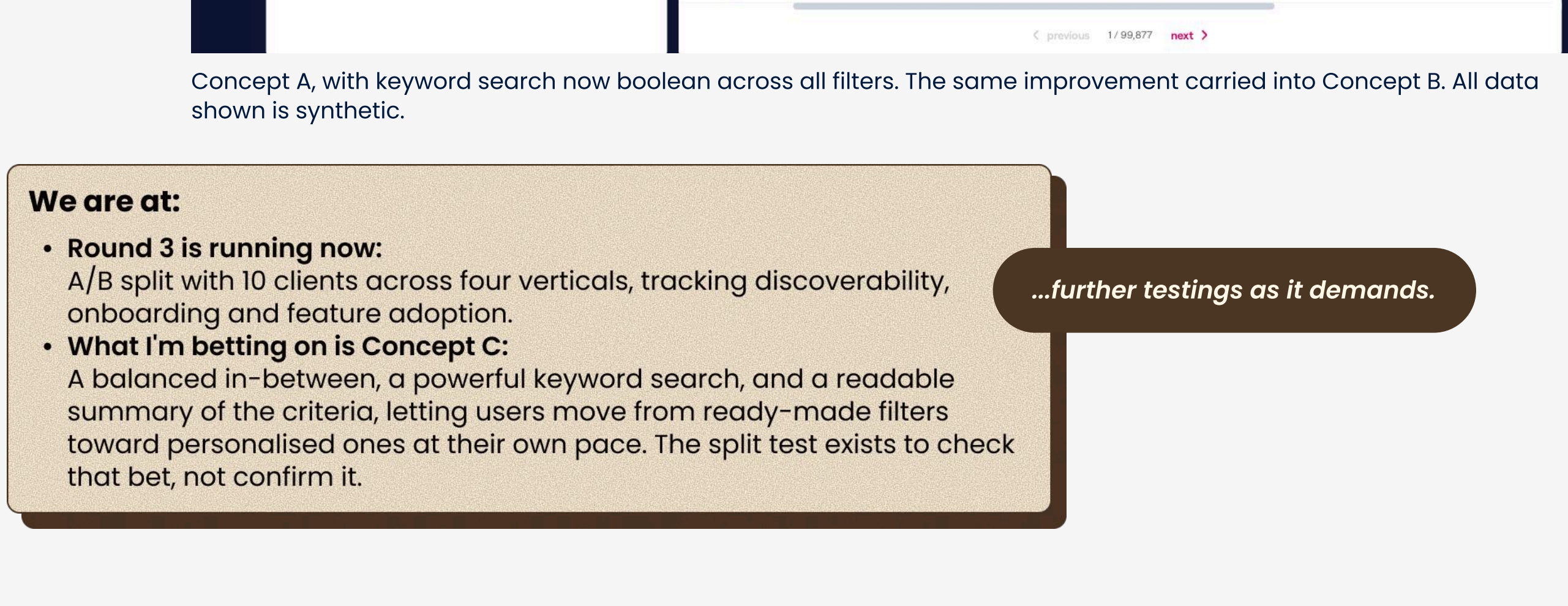
10 Clients from a minimum 4 verticals

A/B Split Design research method

30-40 mins per session

3 weeks

with interactive prototypes, built with Claude AI



We are at:
Round 3 is running now:
A/B split with 10 clients across four verticals, tracking discoverability, onboarding and feature adoption.
What I'm betting on is Concept C:
A balanced in-between, a powerful keyword search, and a readable summary of the criteria, letting users move from ready-made filters toward personalised ones at their own pace. The split test exists to check that bet, not confirm it.

...further testings as it demands.

